



REACHING FOR
THE STARS

Fatima Yahaya, a 13year girl, who lived with her parents in Anguwar Ihun ka Banza of Damagum community, Fune LGA of Yobe State Nigeria.

From a poor background, Fatima's parents have no formal education, hardly before now have there been anything like community support that could make her parent accountable for her education or even stir up the little desire to go back to school that was in her. Her parents believe education is never important especially for a girlchild and they see it as a total waste of resources since they could barely eat two square meals in a day

Fatima have been hawking for a while now to help her parents raise money to take care of her and her siblings. Dropping out of school was something Fatima never blames her parent for but instead work extra hard, by hawking, and also going from house to house to do people chores and in return, she gets paid while with empty stomach.

“BEING IN SCHOOL IS FATIMA'S EVERYDAY DREAM”. She said, “Joining my friends in school has been my desire since the coming of G4G, even with the lack of opportunities and my parent's poor knowledge of the importance of education, I still admire my friend. And this new thing they were doing really stirs my heart as I was just impressed with their new found knowledge”. She explained. Furthermore, she said that hawking has been her greatest achievement and the only way she makes money even though she faces some few challenges, she never allows herself to be lured by anyone.

Opportunities knocked on her door when the Girls 4 Girls, a Unicef driven program in partnership with Life Helpers and funding support of KFW, selected the only government Primary School in her community, to promote the girl child education by access to basic quality education within a safe learning environment and providing opportunities for girls through life skills development that can help them to cope and overcome the lingering challenges they faced daily.

Fatima, got to hear about the G4G program from her friends in the neighborhood. Any time she goes out hawking, she would sneak into Dogon Rijiya Primary School which is



FACTS ABOUT DAMAGUM

Damagum is located in the region of Yobe. Yobe's capital Damaturu (Damaturu) is approximately 69km / 43 miles away from Damagum.

The distance from Damagum to Nigeria's capital Abuja which is approximately 511 km /313 miles. Damagum is known to be with the largest distance coverage to town.

not far from her house and watch how they pupils are enjoying good education, sometimes she will hear them sing the G4G songs. **“Ina jin dadi idan naji suna waka da magna de yaren da ba nasu ba. Amma yanzu, da na iya waka da Magana kadan,kadan ina kasancewa cikin annushuwa”** (Hausa Language). “Hearing them sing and speak in foreign language (English) amuse me but being able to sing and speak few words like them makes me feel bigger and better”(translated).

She said, with a big smile on her face. Although it was not easy but she found courage to tell her parents about her desire to go back to school and also promised them that she would be fulfilling her duties as a child and never shy away from it. With a promised to go hawking after school in order to sustain the family, my father agreed”, Fatima said.

Expressing her gratitude to UNICEF/ LHI for introducing the G4G program. Fatima is now in Dogon Rijiya Primary School, Damagum, Fune LGA of Yobe State. Even though the transition was difficult, arguing at some point with her peers and struggling to connect with them, Fatimes' desire, zeal, aspiration, patience and parents support started to make out positive result which made her now a vibrant member of the G4G group in her school.

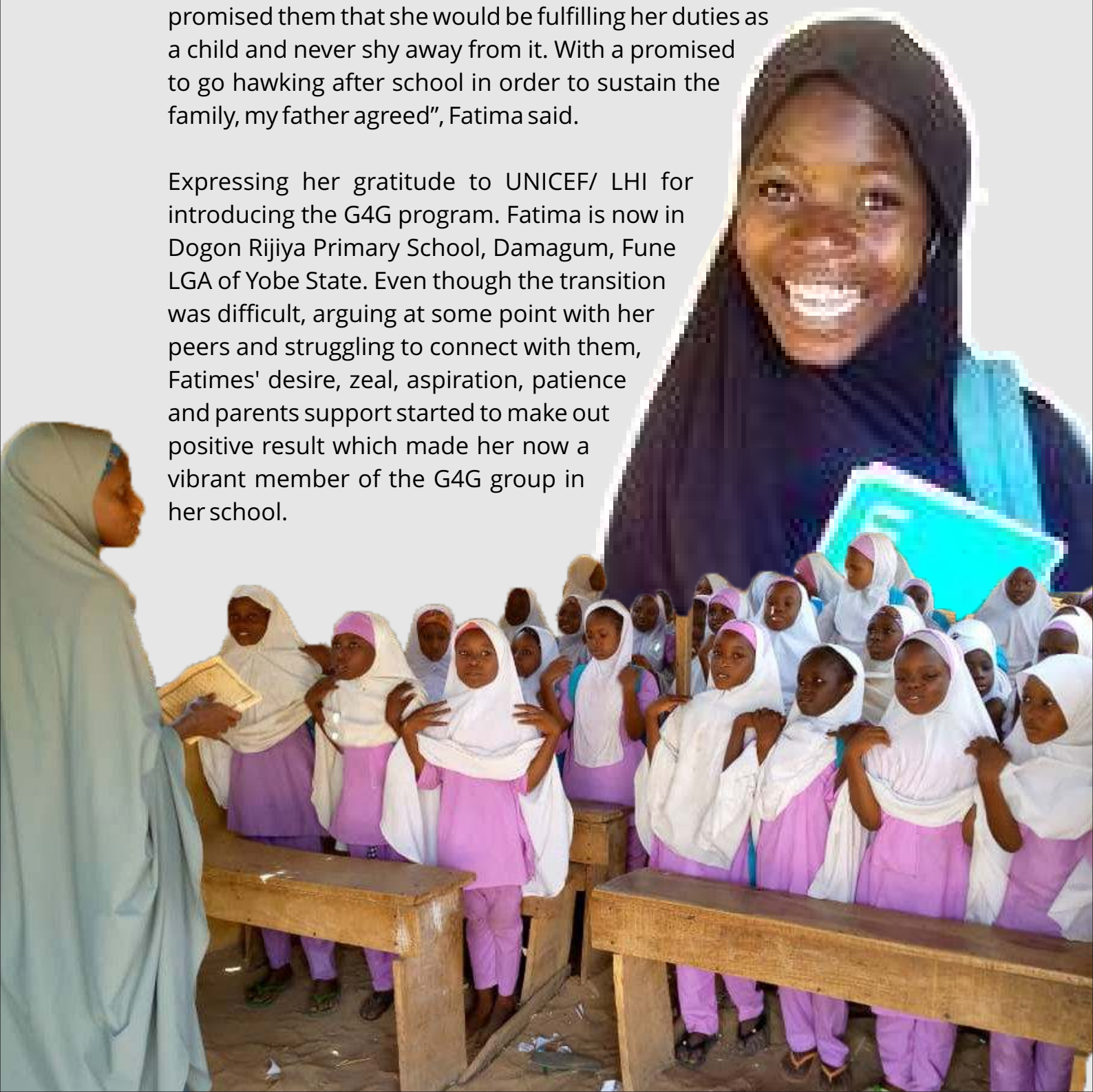


Photo Views



Quarterly review meeting with G4G Reading facilitators



Monthly review meeting with G4G mentors



Spelling bee and Reading festival

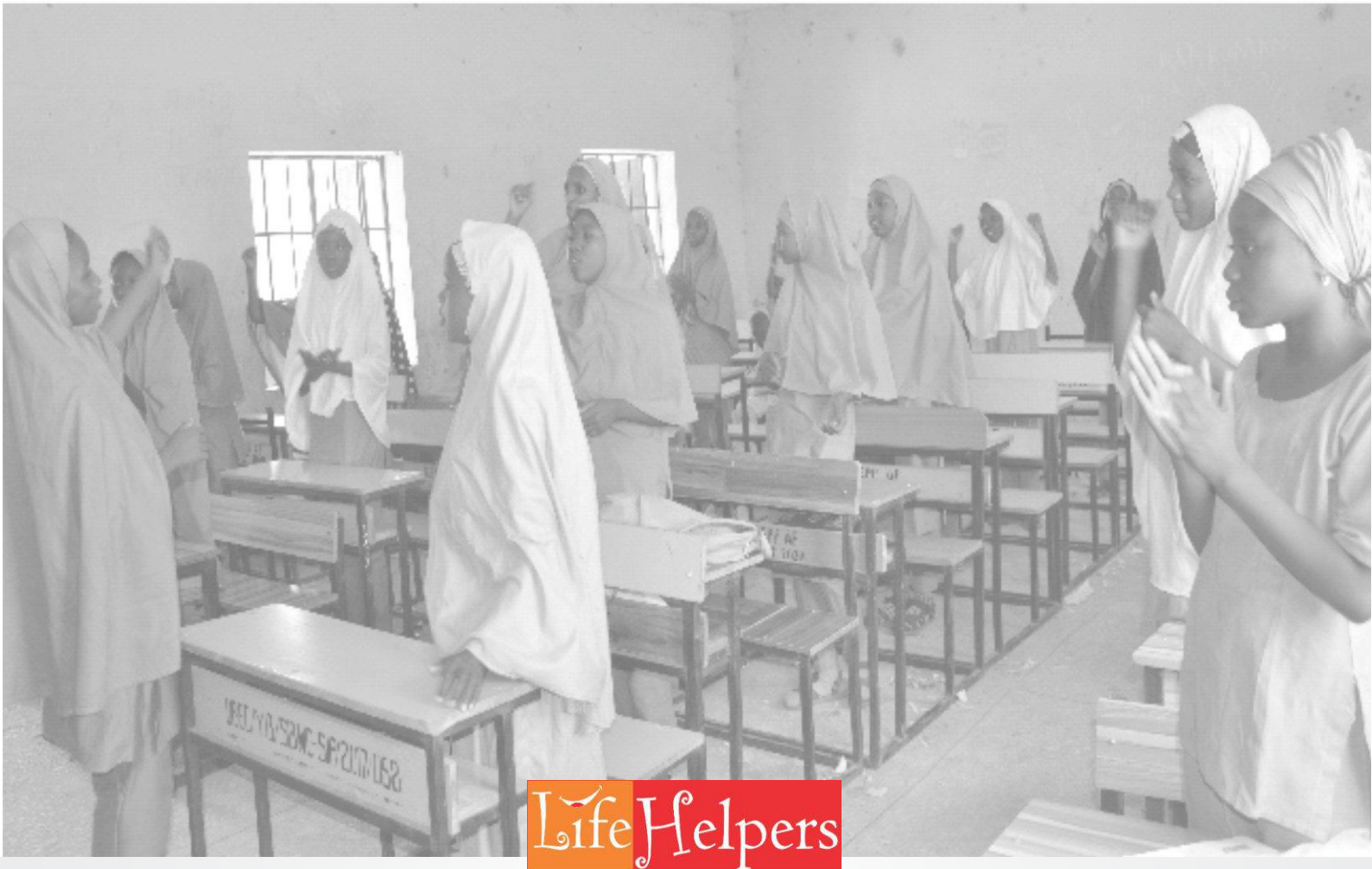


Supportive supervision for G4G and He4she



Biannual Radio program for G4G





LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

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Mission

To be a leading non-governmental organisation empowering children, youths, women and communities to live maximally in all aspect of life through advocacy, capacity development initiatives, community mobbilization and social-economic development.

Vision

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